



▲ VIETNAM SERVICE MEDAL

Date 1965

Origin US

Conflict Vietnam War

Depicting an oriental dragon and a bamboo grove on the front, the Vietnam Service Medal was awarded to military personnel who took part in combat or support operations in Vietnam, Thailand, Laos, or Cambodia between 4 July 1965 and 28 March 1973.



Head of Queen Elizabeth II

▲ VIETNAM MEDAL

Date 1968

Origin Australia/New Zealand

Conflict Vietnam War

The first operational service medal to be designed and produced in Australia, this was awarded to members of the Australian and New Zealand armed forces who served in Vietnam between May 1964 and January 1973. The reverse shows a figure of a man standing between two spheres.

▼ KOSOVO NATO SERVICE MEDAL

Date 1999

Origin NATO

Conflict Kosovo War

This bronze medal bearing the NATO star emblem set in a wreath of olive leaves was first instituted to reward personnel who took part in operations during the Kosovo War (1998–99) in the former Yugoslavia, for 30 days continuous service inside the country.



▲ SOUTH ATLANTIC MEDAL

Date 1982

Origin UK

Conflict Falklands War

The South Atlantic Medal was issued to all UK military personnel involved in the liberation of South Georgia and the Falkland Islands after Argentina's invasion in 1982. The coat of arms of the Falklands appears on the reverse. A rosette on the medal ribbon denotes service in the battle zone.



Lamassu, a winged bull with a man's head

"For Valor" inscribed on scroll

◀ DISTINGUISHED SERVICE CROSS

Date 1918

Origin US

The second highest military decoration after the Medal of Honor, this medal is awarded to US forces for extreme gallantry and risk of life in actual combat. Just over 1,000 were issued in the Vietnam War – 400 of which were awarded posthumously.

◀ IRAQ MEDAL

Date 2004

Origin UK

Conflict Iraq War

This award was given to all military and civilian participants in British actions in Iraq from 2003 to 2011, known as Operation Telic. Those who saw combat from 19 March 2003 were awarded a silver ribbon rosette. The reverse of the medal (shown) depicts a lamassu (a figure from Assyrian mythology).



Cross motif formed by four-bladed propeller

► DISTINGUISHED FLYING CROSS

Date 1927

Origin US

This bronze medal for air crew is given for "heroism or extraordinary achievement while participating in an aerial flight", and has been awarded in all the major US conflicts since its institution, most recently in Iraq and Afghanistan (see pp.436–37).

